

7/25/25

Fisher Hill Association Annual Meeting – Recap

The FHA conducted its annual meeting on June 17th. For the 3rd year in a row, we have held our annual meeting in the historic Ridgeview Congregational Church. I want to thank Roz Carnage and the leadership of the RCC for allowing the FHA to meet once again in the sanctuary of the Church.

We have a number of tasks that we need to complete when holding our annual meeting...and task #1 is signing up new members, updating the contact info of existing members and collecting membership fees. I want to thank Cheryl Daughtrey and JoAnn McLaughlin for the outstanding job they did staffing the sign-in table.

This year's guest speakers were Mayor Tom Roach, Police Chief Joseph Castelli, Deputy Commissioner of Parking & Traffic – Tom Soyk and the 3 candidates running for Mayor of White Plains: Nadine Hunt Robinson (D), Leonard Lolis (R) & Justin Brasch (D).

Mayor Roach has been kind enough to be a guest speaker at the FHA annual meeting for something like 8 of the last 10 years. It has been an honor to have the Mayor Roach address our membership. The Mayor will not be seeking re-election in November. Nevertheless...I felt it important to invite the Mayor to speak to the FHA one more time.

Mayor Roach discussed the following topics:

1. The City of White Plains is in sound financial condition. The City's bond rating is a strong AA+ reflecting the City's solid fiscal management and stable financial position.
2. For the 8th year in a row the City's Budget is "under" the NYS tax cap...without borrowing money for pensions or tax appeals.
3. The City's new Comprehensive Plan was adopted by the City Council. The new Comprehensive Plan will be the City's "roadmap" for the next 10 years.
4. The re-development of the closed Galleria Mall is moving forward. The Developer has submitted their draft environmental impact statement (DEIS) for the project. The Planning Department has accepted the DEIS as complete and will now undertake a review of the DEIS.
5. The City is taking part in the "Vision Zero" initiative to reduce traffic accidents and fatalities. The City has reduced the speed limit from 30mph to 25mph. The Mayor led the effort to allow municipalities the flexibility to lower state-wide speed limits at the local level. The City has installed approximately 300 new speed limit signs throughout the City. There are about 10 streets which are "exceptions" with different posted speed limits in the City.
6. Mayor Roach stated that being the Mayor of White Plains has been thrilling, challenging and the honor of a lifetime.

Police Chief Castelli has also been a frequent guest speaker at our Annual Meeting. Chief Castelli reviewed the public safety statistics for both the City and specifically our Fisher Hill neighborhood. Both the City of White Plains and our Fisher Hill neighborhood are very safe

communities. While there was an uptick in shoplifting in 2024 over 2023...the City and Fisher Hill saw decreases in virtually all other crime categories.

After the meeting.... I asked Chief Castelli if he could provide me with the **actual** crime statistics for both the City and our Fisher Hill neighborhoods. In early July.... the Chief emailed me the City's and Fisher Hill's crime stats. Find a recap of these crime stats below:

1. Total crimes in White Plains from **1/1/24 to 12/31/24** = 1,159 (an increase of 56 incidents over 2023).
2. Total crimes in White Plains "against persons" in **2024**...Homicide, Rape, Assault = 58 (a decrease of 3 incidents from 2023)
3. Total crimes in White Plains "against property" in **2024**...Burglary, Larceny (minor thefts) & Vehicle Theft = 1,101 (an increase of 59 incidents from 2023). Most classifications of crimes "against property" decreased...but incidents of shoplifting increased by 100 and was the reason the total crimes in 2024 increased over 2023.
4. Total crimes in White Plains for the **first 6 months of the 2025** = 472 (a decrease of 67 incidents over the same period in 2024).
5. Total crimes in White Plains "against persons" in the **first 6 months of the 2025** = 27 (a decrease of 2 incidents over the same period in 2024)
6. Total crimes in White Plains "against property" in the **first 6 months of the 2025** = 445 (a decrease of 65 incidents over the same period in 2024)

For Fisher Hill....

1. Total crimes in Fisher Hill from **1/1/24 to 12/31/24** = 53
2. Total crimes in Fisher Hill "against persons" in **2024**...Homicide, Rape, Assault = 5 (1 domestic assault & 4 other assaults)
3. Total crimes in Fisher Hill "against property" in **2024**...Burglary, Larceny (minor thefts) & Vehicle Theft = 19 (5 burglaries, 2 motor vehicle thefts, 12 minor thefts).
4. Total "other" crimes in Fisher Hill in **2024**...like minor assaults, criminal mischief, indecent behavior = 28
5. Total crimes in Fisher Hill for the **first 6 months of the 2025** = 25
6. Total crimes in Fisher Hill "against persons" in the **first 6 months of the 2025** = 1
7. Total crimes in Fisher Hill "against property" in the **first 6 months of the 2025** = 14
8. Total "other" crimes in Fisher Hill in the **first 6 months of the 2025** = 10

For the past year there have been concerns about traffic volumes, speed and safety expressed by residents on or next to Highland Ave and Quinby Ave. Both streets have been used as "cut thru" streets for motorists traveling to or from the Post Road to Fisher & Walworth Avenues.

Accordingly, the FHA asked Tom Soyk, Deputy Commissioner of Parking & Traffic to install speed monitoring devices on Quinby and Highland to collect current traffic volumes and the speeds that these vehicles are traveling. Deputy Commissioner Soyk distributed to the FHA membership printed recaps of the speed and volume statistics that were collected over the course of several months on Quinby and Highland Avenues. Deputy Commissioner Soyk then reviewed with the FHA membership the data collected by the speed monitoring devices. Find a recap below of the data collected by the speed monitoring devices:

Quinby Ave - Speed & Volume Data taken at streets intersecting Quinby Ave... (W. Post Rd, Lynton, Stevens, Wallace, Bogert, Greenacres, Ridgeview, Walworth Terr. & Walworth Ave)

1. 95% of the traffic on Quinby is traveling at 30mph or less.
2. The average volume of traffic on Quinby over a 24-hour period peaks at 2000 vehicles or less.
3. These totals show that during an average 24-hour period...5% of the vehicles (100) on Quinby are traveling above 30mph.

Highland Ave - Speed & Volume Data taken at streets intersecting Highland Ave... (W. Post Rd, Nutgrove, Chestnut, Wyanoke & Fisher Ave)

1. 95% of the traffic on Highland is traveling at 25mph or less.
2. The average volume of traffic on Highland over a 24-hour period peaks at 1900 vehicles or less.
3. These totals show that during an average 24-hour period....5% of the vehicles (95) on Highland are traveling above 25mph.

Deputy Commissioner Soyk explained that while he did not want to discount the traffic safety concerns of residents near Quinby and Highland...but, the data indicates that the vast majority (95%) of vehicles on these streets were traveling at the City-wide 25mph speed limit...or 5pmh above the speed limit. He did point out that the data also shows that on average, 5% of the vehicles on Quinby and Highland are traveling more than the City-wide speed limit.

Westmoreland Ave, a street populated with light industrial buildings, is now on the “radar” of developers looking to convert the industrial buildings into rental apartment projects. The completed Norden Lofts building on Westmoreland is an example of this type of re-development. There are 2 other “site plan approved” re-development projects on Westmoreland (the Westmoreland Lofts project & Mill Creek Project) and a 3rd project (The Sheffield) has been presented to the FHA Board. With a total 400 – 500 new apartments being proposed on Westmoreland Ave....a one way street with existing commercial businesses still operating....I asked Deputy Commissioner Soyk to describe how the City’s traffic department determines whether a particular street has the capacity to support the number of vehicles that the new development will generate. Commissioner Soyk explained that when a Developer would like to build any sort of building in the City...the Developer is asked to engage a Traffic Consulting Engineer to conduct a traffic study which examines the impact of the vehicle traffic that the proposed project will create on streets near the project. The Consulting Engineer’s must consider the vehicular traffic that will be directly related to project as well as the cumulative traffic being generated by other projects in the area that may or may not be built. The last traffic study that was completed for Westmoreland was in 2023 for the proposed 190-unit Mill Creek Project (the Zacky’s warehouse) at 39 Westmoreland. If the Developer for the Sheffield Project submits a proposed re-development of the property between Intervale & Home Streets...he will have to engage a Consulting Traffic Engineer to conduct an updated traffic study that includes the impact of the vehicles directly related to their Sheffield project as well as the vehicles that are related to the Norden Lofts, the Westmoreland Lofts and the Mill Creek project. The Developer will then submit their traffic study to the Traffic Department for review. Commissioner Soyk went on to explain... “Contrary to public beliefs.... the City does not allow Developers to “negotiate” the number of parking spaces required for a particular project. The City’s zoning

ordinance describes the parking requirements for each planning zone in the City of White Plains. Those parking requirements are not negotiable”.

Deputy Commissioner Soyk was asked if stop signs could be added on Quinby at the intersection with Walworth Terrace. He explained that the City of White Plains cannot simply add a Stop sign wherever it thinks it is necessary. The State of New York has specific guidelines which describe the requirements that must be met for a municipality to install a Stop sign. Currently, the intersection of Quinby and Walworth Terrace does not meet the NYS requirements for adding Stop signs.

Deputy Commissioner Soyk was asked if a Traffic Light could possibly be installed at the intersection of W. Post Road and Highland Ave. There is now an entry/exit from the new W.P. Hospital surface parking lot at the intersection of Post Road and Highland Ave. There is also the issue of vehicles (legally) parking close to the NW corner of Highland & Post Rd. Vehicles parked at this corner block the view of vehicles heading south on Post Road.... requiring a vehicle coming down the Highland hill to poke their car out dangerously into the southbound lane of Post Road to view southbound traffic. Commissioner Soyk replied that the traffic department would re-examine the parking positions and sightlines at this intersection. He went on to say that as part of the Hospital's planning for the new surface parking lot...there is a provision to add a Traffic Light at this intersection. The traffic department will also examine whether a Traffic Light is called for at this location.

After Deputy Commissioner Soyk had completed his remarks...I introduced the 3 candidates running for Mayor of White Plains: Fisher Hill resident...Nadine Hunt Robinson (democrat), Leonard Lolis (Republican) & Justin Brasch (democrat). The format for each candidate was as follows: the Candidate will have 15 un-interrupted minutes to introduce themselves and make their case to the FHA membership as to why they should have our vote in November. There would be no debate between the candidates and candidates would not be taking questions from the membership.

At the conclusion of the remarks from the 3 Mayoral Candidates...we turned to Fisher Hill Association business. The Fisher Hill Association's by-laws state that each year we shall conduct an election of Officers and Board Members. Long time FHA Board Member Jane Prout was the "Election Manager" for the 2nd year in a row. In May...Jane contacted each existing Officer and Board Member. She asked each of them, "would they stand for re-election to serve 1 more year in their present position? She also asked if they would like to stand for election to another position or if they would like to step down from the existing position. In addition to Jane's efforts with existing Officers and Board Members....1 month prior to our Annual Meeting.... I sent an email out to the FHA membership inviting anyone interested in standing for election to an Officer or Board Member position to contact Jane Prout prior to the Annual Meeting.

A day or two prior to the Annual Meeting.... I called Jane Prout to learn the results of her conversations with the existing Officers and Board Members...and to learn if anyone from the FHA membership wanted to stand for election. Jane had not received any requests or nominations to stand for an Officer or Board Member position from the FHA membership. Jane reported that all the existing Officers and Board Members agreed to stand for re-election to serve

1 more year.... with one exception. Board Member, Dan Rosenberger, asked to step down from the Board because he simply overstretched for time and could not take part as much as he would like. My thanks to Dan for his service as Board Member of the FHA.

At the Annual Meeting.... Jane Prout stated that the existing Officers and Board Members were all ready to stand for re-election for a new 1-year term of office. She then read the names of the existing Officers and Board Members aloud to the FHA membership.

President – Michael Dalton

Vice- President – Jonna Robins

Treasurer – Joanne Delanoy

Board Members

- Sandra Adams
- Cheryl Daughtrey
- Rodriguez Garner
- Olga Klimek
- Anthony Kuhn
- Wayne McCants
- Joann McLaughlin
- Jane Prout
- Aleta Rice
- Howard & Lea Waldman

A motion was then made to hold a “voice vote” on the existing slate of Officers and Board Members. The motion was seconded. I asked the membership to vote “Aye” or “Nay” when I called for their “voice vote” on the slate of Officers and Board Members. The membership voice voted “aye” to re-elect the existing slate of Officer and Board Members to serve another 1-year term. My thanks to Jane Prout for all her work in reaching out to FHA Officers & Board Members.

In my introductory remarks prior to the election...I explained to the membership that if you’d like to join the Board of the FHA...all you need to do is simply express an interest and ask to join the Board. After we concluded the “election” ...3 FHA members approached me and asked to join the FHA Board.

New Board Members for 2025/26 are:

- Ayanna Faulkner
- Matthew O’Sullivan
- Tania Saiz.

Sincerely,

Michael Dalton

President – Fisher Hill Association

914 497 7236

